

Laboratory Brief 2: Serial Position

Due: Thursday, October 8 at 11:59 PM

Value: 55 points

Format: Individual laboratory brief

Purpose

Use immediate and delayed recall data to evaluate separate explanations for primacy and recency effects.

Your task

- Graph recall proportion by list position for immediate and delayed conditions.
- Calculate mean recall for early positions 1-3 and late positions 10-12 in each condition.
- Explain which portion of the curve changes most after the filled delay and why.
- Evaluate whether the pattern is sufficient evidence for separate short- and long-term stores; name one competing explanation.

Provided evidence or data

Position	Immediate recall	Delayed recall
1	0.84	0.80
2	0.76	0.72
3	0.67	0.64
4	0.59	0.57
5	0.51	0.49
6	0.46	0.44
7	0.43	0.41
8	0.45	0.40
9	0.50	0.42
10	0.61	0.43
11	0.73	0.45
12	0.86	0.47

Submit

- 700-900 word PDF brief with one two-line figure.
- Calculation table for early and late position means.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Question and variables	8	States the question and operational definitions accurately.
Analysis	15	Calculations are correct, transparent, and tied to the supplied data.
Figure or table	10	Presents a labeled, readable display with units and an informative caption.
Interpretation	15	Explains the pattern using the relevant theory without overstating causality.
Limitations and form	7	Identifies a meaningful limitation and follows the brief format.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.